

Taking a Deeper Dive into a Project of National Significance: Community Collaborations for Employment (CCE)



**National Community of
Practice (CoP) series**

September 13, 2022

 **LEWIN GROUP** **TASH**

*This presentation was prepared by The Lewin Group/
TASH under the Administration for Community Living
(ACL), Administration on Disabilities (AoD)
Contract HHSP233201500088I / 75P00120F37007*

Thank You for Joining us for Today's National Community of Practice Webinar

Our program will begin promptly at 3:00 p.m. EST. Until then,
please sit back and enjoy the music!

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Maximizing Your Webinar Participation:

Zoom Tips

- **Audio Settings:** You can change your [audio settings](#). You can also click the upward arrow (^) next to the microphone icon at the lower-left of the Zoom window to change your speaker.
- **Captioning:** Available in a separate browser window by clicking the link to the [following page on Captioned Text](#).
- **Questions:** If you have a question for today's presenters, please type it in the Q&A box at any time during the presentation. You do not have to wait for the Q&A discussion to begin. Open the Q&A window, type in your question, and then press "send." You can also include questions in the chat box. You will receive a reply back via text in the Q&A window or the question will be answered live.

Agenda



- Welcome
- Sonoran University Center for Excellence in Developmental Disabilities
- Kansas University Center on Developmental Disabilities
- Institute for Community Inclusion, UMASS Boston
- Question and Answer Session

Brief Speaker Introductions

**Wendy Parent-
Johnson, PhD**



**Christie
Humphries-
Meninick**



Anya Carrillo



Gabe Martinez



**Evan Dean,
PhD**



**Jenn Bumble,
PhD**



**Brad
Linnenkamp**



**Jennifer
Sulewski, PhD**



Sonoran University Center for Excellence in Disabilities

Project Overview



Finds Their Way: Communities for Youth Transition



Arizona CCE

9/13/2022

 **THE UNIVERSITY OF ARIZONA
COLLEGE OF MEDICINE TUCSON**
**Sonoran Center for
Excellence in Disabilities**

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Overview and Purpose

- Challenges experienced by Native youth with disabilities
- Engage a network of tribal, state, and community partners
- Increase access to culturally responsive services and supports
- Improve employment opportunities and outcomes
- Promote Native youth leaders and advocates
- Develop a Native- and Youth-led transition framework

Our Approach

- Establish a Cross Cultural Tribal Community Collaborative
- Obtain guidance from an Elder advisor and Tribal leader
- Conduct a Talking Circle to gain input and feedback
- Meet with Native youth to learn how we do this
- Create opportunities for Youth to lead and tell their stories
- Develop and share information and resources



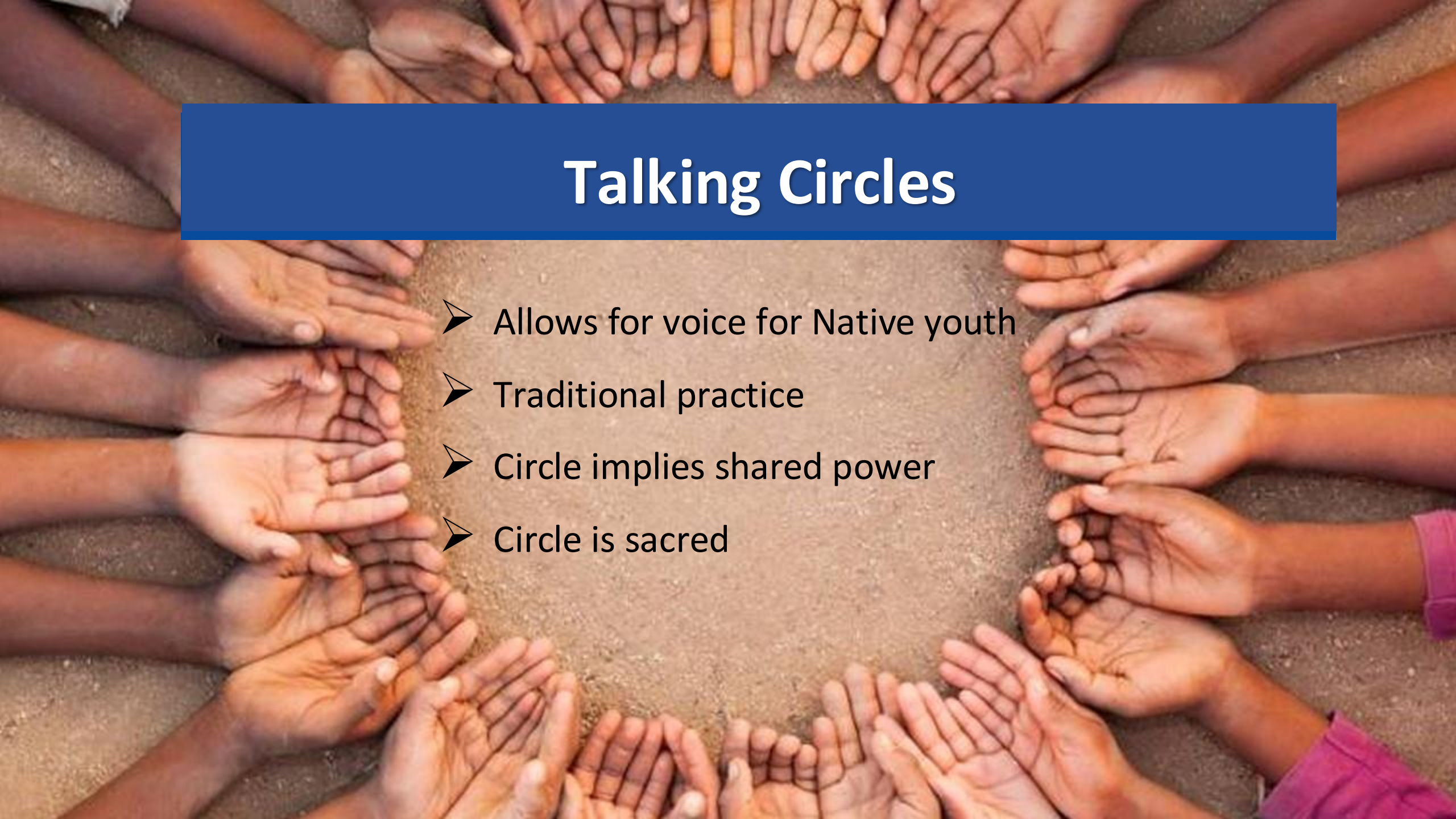
Native disability must include culture and reflect ways of being for tribal people.

- This includes a collectivist ontology-we not me.
- Collaboration-I see you and hear you and other members of our family, community, tribe
- Compassion-we are all in this together
- Courage-we are stronger together

Native Framing of Disability

Decolonized Disability Model



A top-down photograph showing a large number of hands, belonging to people of various ethnicities, arranged in a circle on a sandy surface. The hands are all palm-up, creating a ring of skin tones. A solid blue rectangular banner is superimposed over the upper portion of the image, containing the title text.

Talking Circles

- Allows for voice for Native youth
- Traditional practice
- Circle implies shared power
- Circle is sacred

Completing the Landscape Analysis from an Indigenous Perspective

- Gathering information through interviews and talking circles
- Ensuring multiple perspectives and comprehensive focus
- Importance of personal connections and building bridges
- Designing the format to reflect Native culture
- Making it meaningful for Tribal members and Nations
- What we are hearing: Example Navajo mother and her son

Engaging Youth

- Personal story & Journey
- Youth leadership
- Value of culture and traditions
- Outreach and involvement
- Mentorship of other Native Youth
- Importance of Peer Support in Youth programs

Achieving Employment

- Personal story & Journey
- What young adults with disabilities are telling us
- Work experiences in high school
- Employment programs after high school
- Community help and supports
- Listen; Give youth a chance to look forward

Tips and Lessons Learned

- Engage diverse voices for the community where you wish to serve or provide services
- Be open to learning about culture-importance of respect and humility
- Youth are the experts on their needs, strengths, and abilities we can provide opportunities for growth in those areas
- Youth are leaders now and in the future



THE UNIVERSITY OF ARIZONA
COLLEGE OF MEDICINE TUCSON

**Sonoran Center for
Excellence in Disabilities**



Wendy Parent-Johnson
Executive Director



Anya Carrillo
**Youth Engagement
Coordinator**



Gabe Martinez
Project Co-Coordinator



**Christie Humphries-
Meninick**
**Finds Their Way,
Coordinator**

Finds Their Way Team

Kansas University Center on Developmental Disabilities

Project Overview



My Transition My Career – Youth Led Systems Change



Evan Dean
Brad Linnenkamp
Jenn Bumble

September 13, 2022

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My Transition, My Career Team



Sheida Raley



Sean Swindler



Evan Dean



Baylee Kilburn



Brad Linnenkamp



Jenn Bumble



Karrie Shogren



Jonathan Martinis

Statewide Partners



My Transition My Career Project Goals

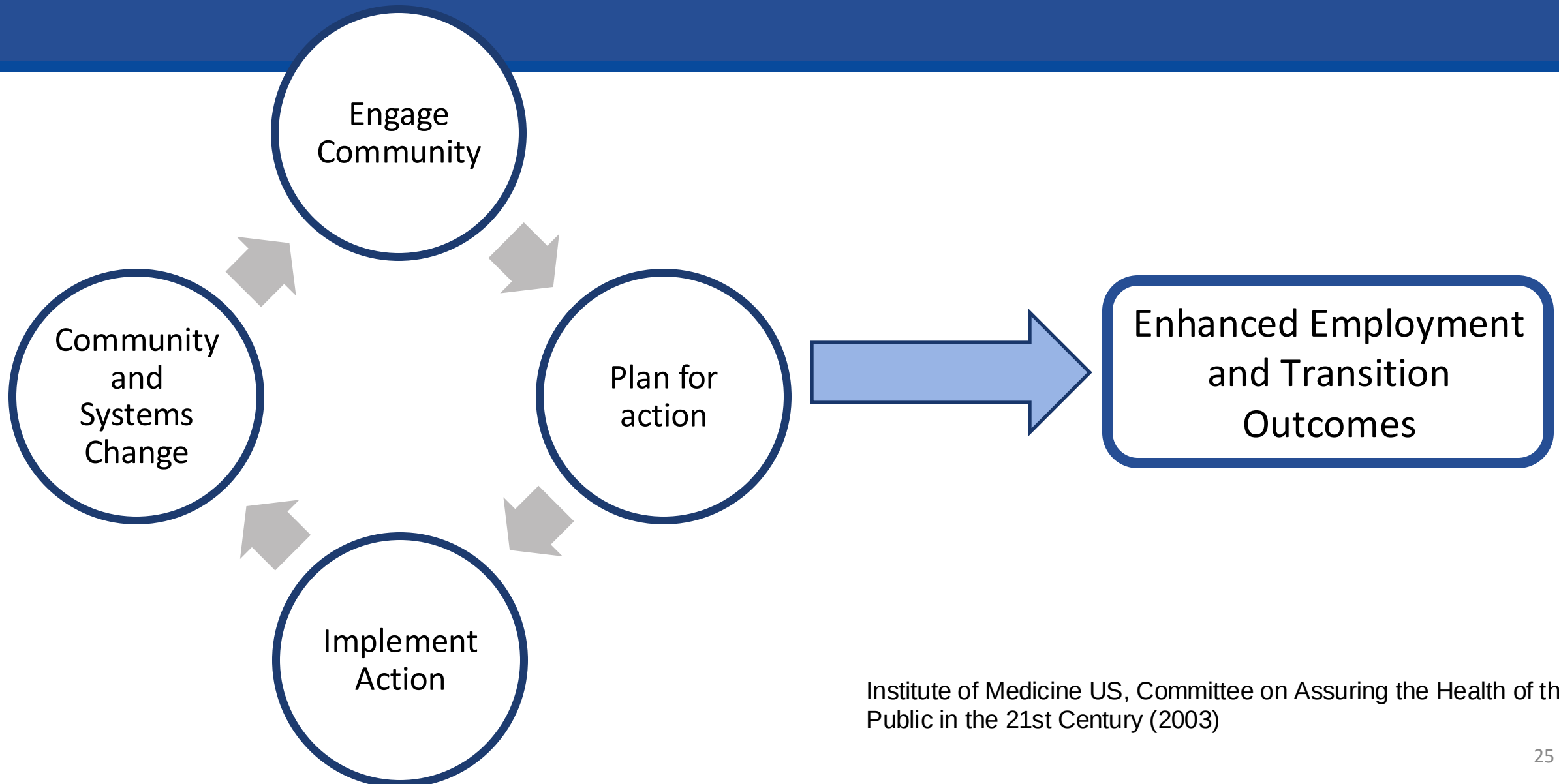
Establish sustainable community partnerships of diverse stakeholders to facilitate youth-led systems change focused on expanding and enhancing the transition and employment service system in Kansas.

Focus of My Transition My Career Projects

- Leverage the strengths of communities to identify new pathways for supporting student transition and employment goals and
- Empower and support self-advocates and family members to be leaders
- Engage people from culturally and linguistically diverse communities
- Support people with disabilities, families, community members and allies, education professionals, employment, and health care providers to implement effective ways to empower young adults with disabilities



My Transition, My Career Systems Change Process



Institute of Medicine US, Committee on Assuring the Health of the Public in the 21st Century (2003)

Youth-Led Community Team Framework

Establish Community Team (6 months)

- 1) Engage culturally and linguistically diverse self-advocates and family members in leadership of the community team
- 2) Identify Community Team leaders and members, including leaders from culturally and linguistically diverse communities
- 3) Establish a process that promotes equitable contribution

Identify Community Strengths and Create Plan (6 months)

- 1) Conduct policy and process analysis
- 2) Identify community strengths and assets
- 3) Create community team plan that includes implementing at least 1 evidence-based practice and holding three community events

Create Action (12 months)

- 1) Hold 3 community events to engage diverse stakeholders (e.g., employers, people from culturally and linguistically diverse communities)
- 2) Implement at least 1 evidence-based or promising practice with technical assistance from KUCDD
- 3) Monitor changes in policy and process

Plan for the Future (12 months)

- 1) Identify procedures and plan for sustaining community team
- 2) Connect community team with other communities
- 3) Identify technical assistance that KUCDD and other partners can provide

Community Strength and Need Identification

Existing Services and Supports

- State-wide listening sessions
- Meeting notes from meetings with schools, self-advocates, and community teams
- Internet research

Experiences with services and supports

- Meeting notes from community team meetings
- Listening Sessions with family members and youth, particularly culturally and linguistically diverse family members and youth
- Interviews with community team members

Community Strengths and Assets

- Mapping Assets for Postschool Success (MAPS)

Existing Services and Supports

TRANSITIONING FROM HIGH SCHOOL IN KANSAS

Experiences of Self-Advocates, Families, and Professionals

WHAT WE DID

KUCDD and SACK facilitated 7 listening sessions so we could hear what Kansans have to say about young people with intellectual and developmental disabilities (ID/DD) transitioning from high school.

WHAT WE LEARNED

Communication between transition stakeholders affects the transition process for the student and can be a barrier to successful outcomes and family engagement when difficult.

Expectations for student outcomes need to be much higher for students with ID/DD to enhance transition outcomes.

Fully and meaningfully including students with ID/DD in the transition planning process leads to positive outcomes. All students need to be fully included.

WE HEARD FROM

10

Self-Advocates

10

Family Members

11

Educators

7

Employment Support Providers

10

State Agency Representatives

WHAT WE HEARD

Communication and Collaboration

"Silos lead to three plans: special education plan, VR plan, Medicaid waiver plan, with goals that are either redundant or contradictory. How does someone succeed when you've got three plans pulling you in three different directions?"
- Transition Coordinator



"It also helps when parents, the school district, and the community work together to build capacity so that there are multiple opportunities for community-based experiences. But that doesn't usually happen."
-Family Member of a Child with ID/DD

Raising Expectations



"After graduating from high school, it was kind of hard. I kind of graduated to the couch, as it were. And I watched a lot of C-Span and play video games." -Self-Advocate

"My son is struggling to find a provider. So he is sitting in my house all day, and I'm kind of done with that because he's capable of working or potentially going to school."
-Family Member of Person with ID/DD

Including Students in Planning

"We have employment specialists finding students jobs, but they're not jobs that the kids like or that they could see themselves doing in the future. So most of the time, they hardly last a week or two, and sometimes it's things that they completely hate."
-Family Member of Person with ID/DD



"What worked best for me is that I made the decisions, nobody else made the decisions." -Self-Advocate

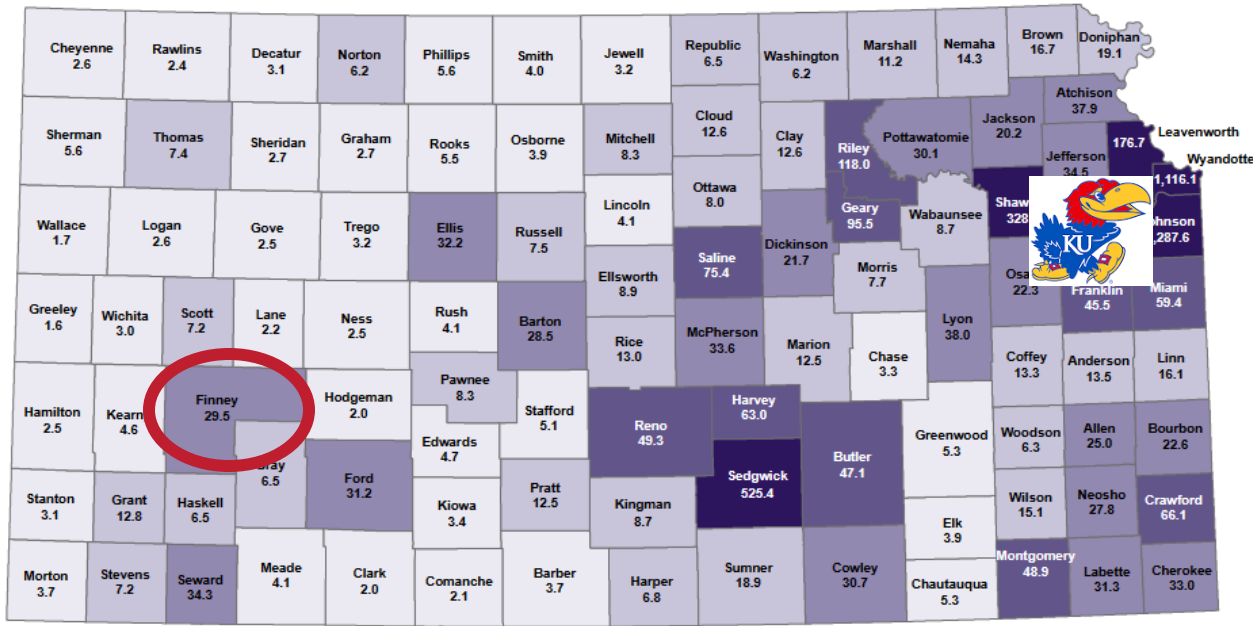
For more information, contact: Evan Dean
edean2@ku.edu | 785.864.1644



KU THE UNIVERSITY OF KANSAS
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF OF STAFF

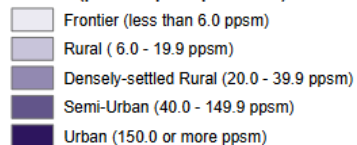
Garden City Demographics (U.S. Census Bureau, 2020)

Population Density Classifications in Kansas
by County, 2020



Source: Institute for Policy & Social Research, The University of Kansas;
data from the U.S. Census Bureau, 2020 Census.

Population Density by Classification*
(persons per square mile)



* Kansas Department of Health and Environment classifications.

State: 35.9

- Population: 28,000
- Race:
 - 77% White alone,
 - 5% Black alone,
 - 5% Asian alone,
 - 7% Two or more races
- Ethnicity: 50% Hispanic or Latinx
- Population Density: Rural
(Institute for Policy and Social Research, 2020)

Garden City Community Team's Plan



- Engaging Community Connectors to engage Hispanic and Latinx families (Garden City Public Schools, Families Together)
- Goal 1: Building Opportunities
- Goal 2: Enhancing Supports and Services



-
- Transition planning
 - Career exploration
 - Community engagement
 - Advanced technology integration

What is a community resource map?

MOVING BEYOND SCHOOLS



- Vocational Rehabilitation
- Vocational training program
- Pre-employment Transition Services
- Supported employment providers
- Higher ed program for indiv. with IDD
- Center for Independent Living
- Group homes or supported living providers
- Social Security
- Recreational programs
- Disability advocacy groups
- Dept. of Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities
- Support groups
- Mental health services
- Adult day programs
- Specific disability providers



- U.S. Armed Forces
- Job Corps
- American Job Centers
- Local employers
- Craft apprenticeship programs (e.g., electrical, carpentry)
- Vocational training programs
- 2-year colleges
- 4-year colleges
- Juvenile Justice Center
- Recreational or social orgs
- Service organizations
- Local transportation providers
- Chamber of Commerce
- Faith communities
- Leaders from local government

tennesseeworks
Creating Employment Outcomes
www.tennesseeworks.org
Community Resource Guide
March 2014

Community Resource Guide

The Nashville metro area has many agency organizations that help students with disabilities as they transition from school to adult life. However, it is often overwhelming to navigate the complex constellation of organizations, agencies, and services that can provide assistance during the transition process. The TennesseeWorks Partnership has adapted a community resource guide to the Center on Secondary Education for Students with Autism (CSESA) compiled the Nashville region to help teachers know about all of the supports available to their students. These resources include:

- Advocacy Supports
- Employment Agencies/Organizations
- Postsecondary Opportunities
- Transportation Supports
- Disability Resources for Immigrant or Spanish-speaking Families
- General Disability Resources
- Disability-Specific Resources
- Recreation Programs, Day Services, and Respite Care Services

Advocacy Supports for Parents

Disability Law & Advocacy Center (DLAC) of Tennessee	Advocacy, training, and mediation for Tennesseans with disabilities	2416 21st Avenue South Suite 100 Nashville, TN 37212	(615) 268-1080 Toll-Free: (800) 343-1660 www.dlac.org
The Kids' Rights Program	Advocacy and legal representation for students with disabilities in Metropolitan Nashville Public Schools (MNPS)	Juvenile Justice Center 100 Woodland Street Nashville, TN 37213	(615) 880-3710
Legal Aid Society of Middle Tennessee & The Cumberland, Nashville	Free legal help to low-income families	300 Deadrick Street Nashville, TN 37203	(615) 244-6610 Toll-Free: (800) 238-1443 www.lai.org
Special Education Advocacy Center	Advocacy for educational rights and family support for students with disabilities; services are non-legal	4322 Harding Pike, Suite 417, PMB 87 Nashville, TN 37205	(615) 777-8515 www.specialeducationadvocacycenter.org
STEP: Support and Training for Exceptional Parents Tennessee Justice Center	Workshops, trainings, support with IEP meetings, Public law and advocacy firm specializing in helping families with special needs	955 Woodland Street Nashville, TN 37206 301 Charlotte Avenue Nashville, TN 37203	615-463-2310 www.trjpc.org (615) 255-0331 Toll-Free: (877) 608-1009 www.trjpc.org



Taking our maps digital

The screenshot displays a digital map interface with a sidebar on the left containing several layers:

- Sample Virtual Community Resou...**
8 views
Last edit was seconds ago
- Add layer** | **Share** | **Preview**
- ☒ **Career Development and Employ...**
 - Individual styles
 - Vocational Rehabilitation
- ☒ **Academic Readiness and Success**
 - Individual styles
 - Local Parent Taskforce
 - CCAC Allegheny Campus Bo...
 - CCAC Student Service Center
 - Allegheny Intermediate Unit
 - EVOLVE Coaching
- ☒ **School Engagement**
 - Individual styles
 - CCAC Allegheny Campus
 - Starbucks
 - CCAC GYM
- ☒ **Independent Living**
 - Individual styles
 - Lehigh Valley Center for Inde...
 - The Arc Of Lehigh & Northam...
 - Home
 - Disability Options Network
 - National Aviary
 - West Park - Lake Elizabeth
 - Allegheny General Hospital E...
 - Diversity Park Activities De...
 - Mechanicsburg

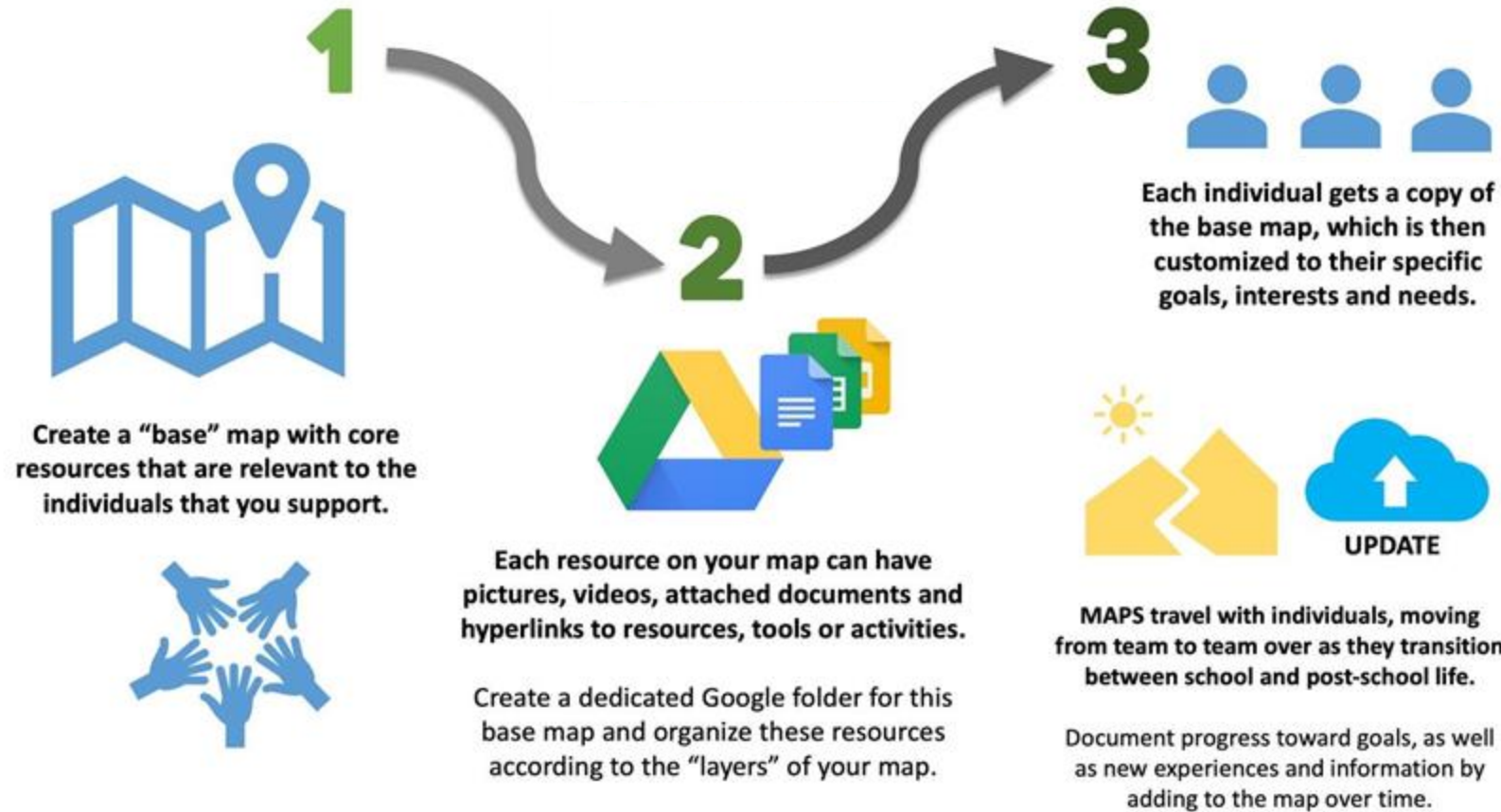
The main map area shows a detailed view of the Lehigh Valley region. Two pop-up information cards are visible:

- Lehigh Valley Center for Independent Living (LVCiL)**
1 of 1
At LVCiL, we believe that every individual has the right to live a healthy, happy, and productive life in a community that is free from all barriers. We can help you achieve or maintain your independence through many of our supportive services and programs, including our five core services: Information and Referral, Peer Support, Advocacy, Independent Living Skills, and Transition Services for Youth and Older Adults. In addition, we also provide specialized services, such as spe housing search and support, services for Veterans, 24-hour sign language services transition services for youth, employment services, supports coordination under se
- Local Parent Taskforce**
This Taskforce meets each week to discuss parent concerns. Call Judy friendly to attend at 616-999-9222

Another pop-up card shows a video of a man in a red shirt, identified as Mike, a counselor, with text describing his role and the VR training he is receiving.

Fully customized, online *interactive* resource map

1. Organizes all current transition resources with interactive media (images, video, text, links) and power of google (forms, uploads)
2. Collaborative tool to share with colleagues, students, and families



Transitions resource mapping to a youth-driven, experiential learning process

- Community navigation (schedule)
- Career exploration
- A person-centered plan that can grow with them as they move from the school system to the service system (virtual resume or portfolio)

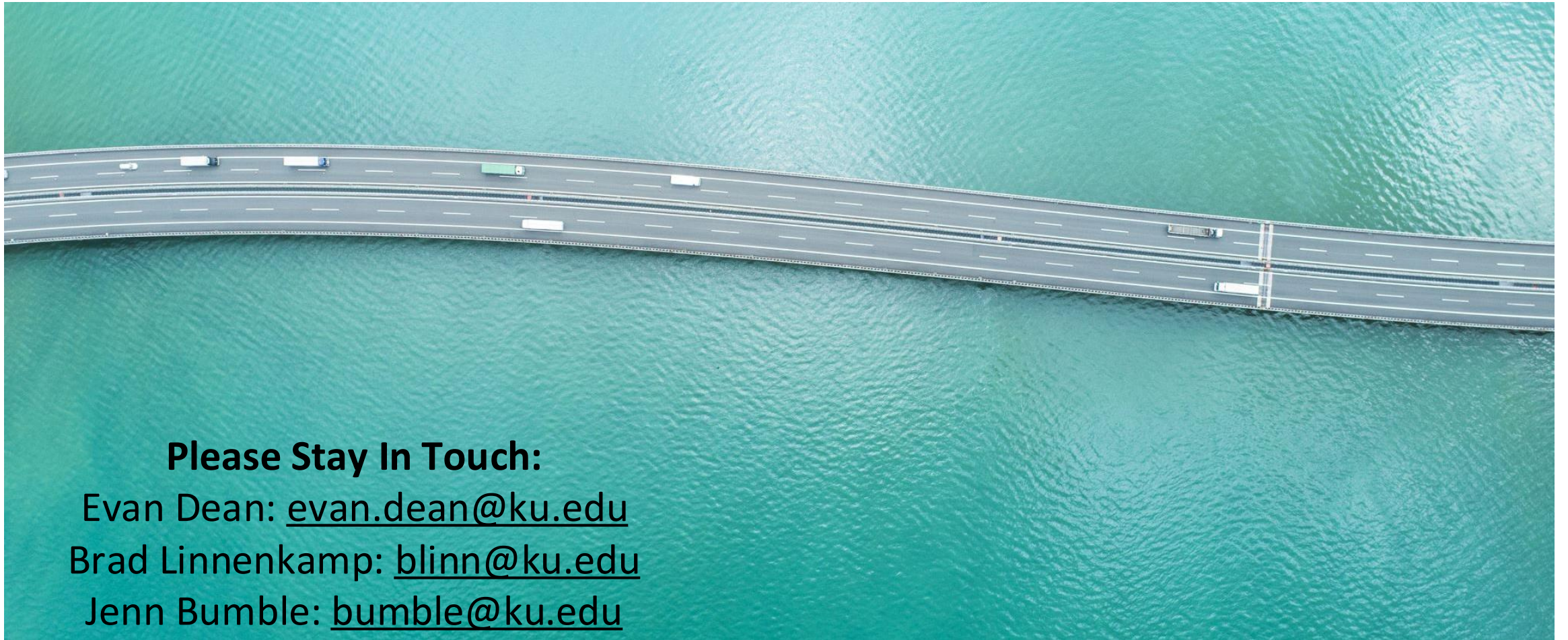
Creates a one-stop-shop

- Assessments
- Evaluations
- Ecological assessments
- Reflections
- Videos
- PCP meeting notes
- Grades
- Assignments
- Experiences

The screenshot displays the MAPS application interface, which is a map-based platform for youth-driven experiential learning. The main map shows a portion of Memphis, Tennessee, with various locations marked. Overlaid on the map are several information panels:

- Erika's Memphis MAP:** A panel on the left side of the map showing a list of items: "All About Me!" (with sub-items: "Individual styles", "My Postsecondary goals and...", "My vision board for my IEP m...", "Me!"), "My Support Circle" (with sub-items: "My family", "Memphis Center for Independ...", "Collierville High School", "The Arc Mid-South"), and "Let's Work" (with sub-items: "Vocational Rehabilitation", "Collierville Animal Clinic", "Memphis Veterinary Sp...").
- Me!:** A panel on the right side of the map showing a photo of a young woman (Erika) and a text description: "My name is Erika. I looove animals and I want to work as a vet tech. I want to work in a casual place with friendly people. I don't...".
- Residences At Lakeview:** A panel on the right side of the map showing a photo of a residential building and a list of likes: "1) Not too far from parents", "2) Close to a bus stop for work", "3) Places to eat and shop are right near by, some are even in the building!".
- Vocational Rehabilitation Office:** A panel on the right side of the map showing a photo of a man (Mike) and a text description: "My VR Counselor's name is Mike. Here is his picture and a video about VR. Mike is going to help me get extra training when I am at work so that I can accomplish the goals Dr. Peter gives me each day. My counselor is also helping me learn how to take the bus to my classroom because there are a...".
- Glenclyff High School:** A panel at the bottom of the map showing a photo of the school building and a text description: "My teacher at Glenclyff is Mr. D. He takes us to work at the hospital during the week. That's where I learned that I like to help people and animals get better, My class is a community-based transition program. Here is the website <https://www.mnps.org/learn/academics/student-with-disabilities/transition-services>".

Thank You!



Please Stay In Touch:

Evan Dean: evan.dean@ku.edu
Brad Linnenkamp: blinn@ku.edu
Jenn Bumble: bumble@ku.edu

Institute for Community Inclusion – UMASS Boston

Project Overview



Lawrence Partnership for Transition to Employment

Massachusetts

September 13, 2022



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Project Goals

Listen to parents,
students,
community
members



Improve transition
to work supports
for youth in
Lawrence



Better transition
outcomes for
youth

Framework: Collaborating for Equity and Justice

6 Principles:

1. Directly address race, ethnicity, and social class.
2. Give equal power to community members in deciding what's important to work on.
3. Work to build leadership and power among community members.
4. Focus on changing whole systems, not just local programs.
5. Look to research on what works.
6. Support the group members to lead the work.

Wolff et al., 2017 <https://nonprofitquarterly.org/collaborating-equity-justice-moving-beyond-collective-impact/>

Key Project Partners

- Institute for Community Inclusion (ICI)
- Lawrence Public Schools
- The Arc of Greater Haverhill-Newburyport
- Fidelity House Career Resources Corporation
- Northeast Independent Living Program
- Northern Essex Community College
- Merrimack Valley Workforce Board
- Merrimack Valley Regional Transit Authority
- MA Department of Developmental Services
- MA Developmental Disabilities Council
- MA Rehabilitation Commission
- MassFamilies
- Massachusetts Advocates for Children

Accomplishments to Date

- Convened 43-member multi-stakeholder consortium partnership and steering committee
- Facilitated discussion on cross-cultural collaboration
- Begun community landscape analysis
- Preparing for community conversations series (Oct 2022)

Lessons Learned

- Having a strong level of interest of partners from the start is important
- Even with initial commitments, it takes time to build relationships and trust
- Conducting meetings in multiple languages takes a lot of planning and attention to detail!

Question and Answer Session

- Let's hear from you!
- Please type in a question in the chat box and we will try our best to answer your questions.



Upcoming Webinar: Thinking Outside the Box: States' Journey in Using ARP Funding to Increase CIE

October 11, 2022: 3:00-4:30 PM EST

Speakers: 3-4 States Using Bump in [ARP](#)
Funding to Increase CIE & Enhance Resources
to Employment

Register: <https://bit.ly/DETAC-CoP-Oct-11-2022>



New DETAC Publications

- **Self-Employment Brief:**
<https://aoddisabilityemploymenttcenter.com/wp-content/uploads/2022/08/DETAC-Self-Employment-Brief.pdf>
- **Podcast: The Business Side of Things: Employment and Brain Injury:** <https://aoddisabilityemploymenttcenter.com/the-business-side-of-things-employment-and-brain-injury/>

Need to Help to Advance Your Systems Change Efforts? Reach Out!

- **Submit your request to the:**
[on-demand TA request page](#)
- **Reach out by emailing:**
AoDeploymentTA@gmail.com



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<https://aoddisabilityemploymenttcenter.com/detac-publications/>

